

MARCH 8, 2026



ST. BENEDICT PARISH

ST. BRIDGET'S CHURCH · ST. MARY'S CHURCH · ST. MARY'S SCHOOL
CALVARY CEMETERY · ST. BRIDGET'S CEMETERY

Striving to know, love, and serve God in all others.

OUR PRIESTS

Fr. Michael Costik, Pastor

Fr. Simon Atta Denchira, Parochial Vicar

Fr. Brian Plate, Resident Priest & VA Chaplain

OUR CHURCHES



ST. BRIDGET'S CHURCH
15 Church St, Bloomfield NY 14469



ST. MARY'S CHURCH
95 N Main St, Canandaigua NY 14424

OUR PARISH OFFICE



PARISH ADMINISTRATION CENTER
95 N Main St, Canandaigua NY 14424
(585) 394-1220
www.stbenedictonline.org

OUR SCHOOL



ST. MARY'S SCHOOL
16 Gibson St, Canandaigua NY 14424
Mrs. Cristina Falbo, Principal
(585) 394-4300
www.stmaryscanandaigua.org

THIRD SUNDAY OF LENT



"A woman of Samaria came to draw water. Jesus said to her, 'Give me a drink.'"
~ Jn 4:7-8

Gospel Reflection by Fr. Michael

These readings in Lent are truly awesome. They are used to prepare catechumens for baptism. So what do they have in common other than this use?

This week, we hear the proclamation of the Samaritan Woman at the Well — I believe this is the longest single narrative in the gospel accounts. This woman, whom Jesus was not supposed to speak to, has a conversation. And in that conversation she gains a power; she becomes something she couldn't otherwise become by virtue of it.

That we each become powerful in our own encounter with Christ is the idea we celebrate here. What impossible thing has been worked in you because you know Jesus Christ?

For the faithful, we understand that the great impossibility that we share is that we have and share his life with him. We become more ourselves than we would otherwise be because of him. These three things: the Woman at the Well, the Man Born Blind, and the Raising of Lazarus, each fit this mold; someone confesses that Jesus is the Christ and an impossibility becomes possible.

So we pray for those about to be baptized as we also pray for our own baptism. May we be ever grateful for all that we receive in encountering Christ. ~MC



FAITH: LITURGIES & SERVICES

March 8, 2026

LITURGIES

Sunday, March 8, 2026

THIRD SUNDAY OF LENT

Daylight Saving Time begins

Readings: Ex 17:3-7/Ps 95:1-2, 6-7, 8-9/Rom 5:1-2, 5-8/Jn 4:5-42 or 4:5-15, 19b-26, 39a, 40-42

Responsorial Psalm: *If today you hear his voice, harden not your hearts.* ~Ps 95

Saturday, 3/7—Sunday anticipated, 5:30pm (SM) **Ruth O'Donnell** by Mary Clement & family

7:30am (SM) **Isabel Brooker** by her son, Jim

9am (SM) **Anthony & Catherine Garofola** by the family

10:30am (SB) **All Who Died Due to Violence & War**

12pm (SM) **Theresa Lacognato** by Annette Leopold

4pm (SM) *Lenten Evening Prayer*

Monday, March 9, 2026

Lenten Weekday

St. Frances of Rome, Religious

Readings: 2 Kgs 5:1-15ab/Ps 42:2, 3; 42:3, 4/Lk 4:24-30

9am (SM) **Our Enemies & Those with Whom We Do Not See Eye to Eye**

Tuesday, March 10, 2026

Lenten Weekday

Readings: Dn 3:25, 34-43/Ps 25:4-5ab, 6 and 7bc, 8-9/Mt 18:21-35

9am (SB) **Gerry Costa** by Mary & Mike Broderick

Wednesday, March 11, 2026

Lenten Weekday

Readings: Dt 4:1, 5-9/Ps 147:12-13, 15-16, 19-20/Mt 5:17-19

8:30am (off site) *Communion Service at Clark Manor House*

9am (SM) **The Vulnerable & Marginalized**

Thursday, March 12, 2026

Lenten Weekday

Readings: Jer 7:23-28/Ps 95:1-2, 6-7, 8-9/Lk 11:14-23

9am (SB) **The Sick, the Suffering, & the Sorrowful**

Friday, March 13, 2026

Lenten Weekday

Readings: Hos 14:2-10/Ps 81:6c-8a, 8bc-9, 10-11ab, 14 and 17/Mk 12:28-34

9am (SM) **Flora & Belmont Avoli** by Steven & Dawn DeMott

Saturday, March 14, 2026

Lenten Weekday

Readings: Hos 6:1-6/Ps 51:3-4, 18-19, 20-21ab/Lk 18:9-14

9am (SM) **Lynnette Ward** by Mike & Mary Broderick

Sunday, March 15, 2026

FOURTH SUNDAY OF LENT

Readings: 1 Sm 16:1b, 6-7, 10-13a/Ps 23:1-3a, 3b-4, 5, 6/Eph 5:8-14/Jn 9:1-41 or 9:1, 6-9, 13-17, 34-38

Responsorial Psalm: *The Lord is my shepherd; there is nothing I shall want.* ~Ps 23

Saturday, 3/14—Sunday anticipated, 5:30pm (SM) **Michael Lally** by Melanie & Bryan Kransler

7:30am (SM) **Anne Erdle** by Mary Jo Zahn & family

9am (SM) **Mery Genecco** by the family

10:30am (SB) **The Deceased Priests, Deacons, & Religious of the Diocese of Rochester**

12pm (SM) **Theresa Lacognato** by Joe Clement

4pm (SB) *Lenten Evening Prayer*

(SB) St. Bridget's Church, (SM) St. Mary's Church

Note: The Mass schedule is subject to change due to the availability of the priest(s).

MASS ATTENDANCE

February 28 & March 1, 2026

5:30pm Saturday at St. Mary's: 221

7:30am Sunday at St. Mary's: 160

9am Sunday at St. Mary's: 360

10:30am Sunday at St. Bridget's: 121

12pm Sunday at St. Mary's: 232

Total in Attendance: 1,094

ALTAR MEMORIALS

March 8-15, 2026

St. Mary's Church: This week, the Bread & Wine will be offered in loving memory of Antonio Ceravolo, requested by his wife. The Sanctuary Lamp will also burn in loving memory of Antonio Ceravolo, requested by his wife.

To reserve an altar memorial at St. Bridget's Church or St. Mary's Church, please contact our parish receptionists, Maureen Horrocks or Angela Lenzo, at (585) 394-1220, ext. 110.

ADORATION

St. Mary's Church: Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament & Adoration is offered on the First Saturday of each month from 6:30pm-7:30pm. All are welcome.

What is Eucharistic Adoration & Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament?

Eucharistic Adoration is a Catholic devotion dating back to the early days of the Church. It involves exposing a consecrated host, the Blessed Sacrament, allowing people to sit and pray in the presence of Jesus Christ.

Adoration specifically refers to any prayer in front of the Blessed Sacrament whether in front of a closed Tabernacle or in front of the exposed host in a monstrance. Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament refers specifically to prayer in front of the exposed host in a monstrance. You may hear these terms used interchangeably.

During Eucharistic Adoration, it is appropriate to do any of the following...

- Read and reflect on readings from the Bible or other spiritual writings
- Pray the Rosary, Divine Mercy Chaplet or any other favorite devotions
- Converse with God through spontaneous prayer or journaling
- Sit quietly and listen or just enjoy being in the presence of Christ



PARISH INCLEMENT WEATHER POLICY

Our Parish's Procedure for Weekdays during Inclement Weather:

Ordinarily, if Bloomfield Schools are closed due to inclement weather, there will be no Daily Masses, Confessions, or meetings, etc. held at St. Bridget's Church.

Ordinarily, if St. Mary's School is closed due to inclement weather, there will be no Daily Masses, Confessions, meetings, etc. at St. Mary's Church. In addition, the Parish Administration Center (PAC) will be closed.

Unless a State of Emergency is declared, funerals, weddings, and Sacramental Rites may be an exception to the policy described above and will be determined on an individual basis.

(Note: The above policy applies to weekdays; the DOR/Bishop's office makes decisions about closures affecting Sunday liturgies.)

Updates will be called in to local news stations, posted on our website and social media, and sent via Flocknote as necessary.



FAITH: THIRD SUNDAY OF LENT

Third Sunday of Lent

QUESTIONS OF THE WEEK

Reflect & Respond to Scripture

Live the Liturgy—Inspiration for the Week: Jesus did not convert the Samaritan woman with miracles. He converted her with presence. He was not afraid of her sins or her failures. He listened to her. He sat with her. Let us learn from this: when we are present to others, we can show them the face of God.

Questions of the Week:

1st Reading Question: God answers Moses' prayer of petition to give the Israelites water to drink before they die of thirst in the desert. What would you like to ask from the Lord in the upcoming week?

2nd Reading Question: Paul tells the Romans to have hope because the Holy Spirit pours the love of God into our hearts. What are you hoping for this Lent?

Gospel Question: The Samaritan woman eventually comes to believe in Jesus as the Messiah and savior of the world. What convinces you that Jesus is your Lord and Savior?

Mini Reflection: Before the Incarnation, God looked down from Heaven and said, "You are thirsty. Here is something to drink." After the Incarnation, God sits down beside us and says, "I'm thirsty. Give me something to drink."

Lenten Challenge: Thank someone who once sowed faith into your life. And keep sowing, even when the harvest is unseen. (For more "challenges" see our tips for Living Lent Daily in the Lenten Happenings section on page 7).

FOR THE KIDS

Activities Related to Today's Readings

Puzzle: Unscramble words from today's Gospel

Sychar	well	truth
woman	worship	faith
drink	Father	Savior

Sharing the Gospel:

Jews didn't usually like the people from Samaria, let alone visit one of their towns or talk to any of them. Men didn't usually talk to women back then, either. When Jesus talked to the woman at the well, Jesus broke those silly rules. Jesus saw into the woman's heart and knew that she needed God in her life. Jesus came to rescue her from her sin. She was so happy that she invited everyone in her town to meet Jesus, too.

Prayer: Dear God, thank you for caring about me, no matter where I live, and no matter what I have done wrong.

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Some brief information about the saints whose feast days are this week is included below. This may be helpful information for some of our Confirmation candidates who are currently choosing a Confirmation name as well as others who may have an interest in learning more about the saints. Additional information about the saints can be found at https://www.catholic.org/saints/new_bio.php.

Mar 8: St. John of God, Religious—Optional Memorial

Patron Saint of hospitals, nurses, firefighters, booksellers, alcoholics, & the sick

Birth: 1495; **Death:** 1550

Canonized October 16, 1690 by Pope Alexander VIII

Prayer: Saint John of God, you struggled in many ways throughout your life. Through it all, you never gave up your desire to serve God and others. Please pray for me, especially when I lose hope, that I may imitate your example and offer myself to God for His glory and the service of all. Saint John of God, pray for me. Jesus, I trust in You.



Mar 8: St. Frances of Rome, Religious—Optional Memorial

Patron Saint of motorists and widows

Invoked against the death of children

Birth: 1384; **Death:** 1440

Canonized May 29, 1608 by Pope Paul V

Prayer: Saint Frances of Rome, you loved God with all your heart and served Him at every stage of your life. Please pray for me, that I may learn how to serve God within my vocation, never seeking anything other than His holy and perfect will. Saint Frances, pray for me. Jesus, I trust in You.



HUMOR

3RD SUNDAY OF LENT



3rd SUNDAY OF LENT



Don't throw this bulletin away! Once you've read the bulletin, consider giving it to a friend or acquaintance, along with an invitation to attend Mass at either St. Bridget's Church or St. Mary's Church (or perhaps both!). Being a good steward and sharing the Good News can take many forms!

FAITH: PRAYERS & BLESSINGS

March 8, 2026

PRAYER LIST

Pray for Healing & Comfort, Strength & Endurance

Please pray for healing & comfort for our sick and for strength & endurance for all caregivers.

Have an Update for Someone Already on the Prayer List or Have Someone to Add to the List? Please contact our parish receptionists, Maureen Horrocks or Angela Lenzo, at (585) 394-1220, ext. 110.

A— Marco Alberts Mary Andolsek Marisa Andrews Consuelo Arango Nathaniel Atkins	Regina Haynes Shannon Haynes James Hemler Kathleen Hess James D. Holland Mary Hollis Florence Holloway Ted Horrocks David Hurlbert Charles P. Hyde John W. Hyde Ruth C. Hyde	Becky Rempe Bill Rempe Kathy Revier Tom Revier Wendy Rex Ryder Thomas Rexford Frank Robertaccio James Roblee Sr. Luci Romero Mike Rosenhagen Liz Russotti
B— Frank Badger Marty Badger Phyllis Badger Bill Batson George Bauer Richard Bauer Betty Bement Thomas Bement Anna Bomwell Leanne Bossert David Boyle Marie Brunner Joan Buck Patrick Burns	J— Debra Jacobs K— Michael Kachmar Michael Keenan Tricia Kenney John King Robert Kubiak, Jr. L— Peggy LaRocca Timothy James Leach Dcn. Claude Lester Mike Linse James & Liz Lowe Teresa Lynch Tom Lynch Joan Lyons	S— Liz Salvato Patrick Sawyer Joseph Schepisi Maryann Schu Emily Scorse Phyllis Scott Christina Senska Janet Sheehan Michael Sheehan Vicenza (Vinny) Sinicropi The Skrypek Family Gail Smith Ralph & Mary Smith David Spychalski Dennis Supik
C— Domenica Campagna Dcn. Kevin Carges Robert Casella Michele Cleaves Mary Clement Kim Corron Evan & Sarah Costik Troy Cottman Chris Covell Craig Covell James Curry	M— Tom Macri Mary Malinowski Jim Marianacci Pat McCarthy Barbara & James McKee Terry McKenna Tim McKenna George McMahon Kaleb McWilliams Mary Beth McWilliams Bruce Miles Michele Miles Connie Moffat Fr. Thomas Mull	T— Michael Tedesche Abby Terhune Dan Tidrick Carl Tobin Caroline Torbitt Fr. Dan Tormey Christine Treahy
D— Robert Damato Brenda D'Angelo Tom DeJohn Patrick Delary Jonah DiMitro Sue Dobies Alan & Patricia Donnelly	N— Elizabeth Nares Randall Nellist Connor Nevil Gordon Nicholson Bruce Northridge O— Ethan O'Donnell Patricia O'Donnell Jackie O'Laughlin	V— Vito Valenzano Elaine Vanetta JoAn Van Troost Annette Vitalone Joe Viterna
E— Ruth Enslow Wyatt Erti	W— Jeff Wagar Jim Wagner Barbara Walczak Marcella Walczak The Walczak Family Ron Walker Matthew Wasson Tim Welch David Williams Robert Wilson	Y— Angelicia Yanez
F— Ted Fafinski Pauline Fehrenbacher David Felten Paul Ferraro Steve Finnicks Marilyn Fisher Diane Fudalik Lyla Fulton	P— Christopher Panos Donna H. Patrick Harry Patrick Jeanetta Pharis Lou Pirozzi Rosalie Polimeni David Pratt Chris Pritchard Jacky Protano	...and any other unnamed individuals needing our prayers.
G— SuZanne Gates Adam Genazzio Andrew German Valerie Goldstein Kaylee Goodier Elizabeth Gotham Elodie Graham Barbara Graves Chris Griffith Assunta Guittar Mitch Guittar	R— Dave Read Katie Read	<i>"God of all goodness, look with mercy on all who suffer any kind of infirmity, sickness or injury, that they may be comforted."</i>
H— Jim Harvey Joyce Hatcher		

PRAYER

Prayers for Lent

The Fast Life

Fast from judging others;
Feast on Christ dwelling in them.
Fast from fear of illness;
Feast on the healing power of God.
Fast from words that pollute;
Feast on speech that purifies.
Fast from discontent;
Feast on gratitude.
Fast from anger;
Feast on patience.
Fast from pessimism;
Feast on hope.
Fast from negatives;
Feast on encouragement.
Fast from bitterness;
Feast on forgiveness.
Fast from self-concern;
Feast on compassion.
Fast from suspicion;
Feast on truth.
Fast from gossip;
Feast on purposeful silence.
Fast from problems that overwhelm;
Feast on prayer that sustains.
Fast from anxiety;
Feast on faith.

Invite Us Deeper

Almighty and ever living God, you invite us deeper
into your world, your people, your Lent.
May this time be one of outward focus;
seeking you in those we often ignore.
Help us live a Lent focused on freedom,
generosity, and encounter.
Give us hearts hungry to serve you
and those who need what we have to give.
Amen.

Prayer for the Fourth Sunday of Lent

Loving Father,
So many times I turn away from you
and always you welcome me back.
Your mercy and love gives me confidence
Thank you for the invitation
to share, fast, and pray
so that you can form a new heart within me.
Your powerful compassion for my weaknesses
leads me to ask for mercy
and await with great hope the Easter joy you
share with us.

Prayer of Lent

Dear God,
As I fast, may Your presence be my sustenance.
As I pray, continue to reveal Yourself to me.
As I give to others, may I know You
even more deeply.
Amen.



SACRAMENTS

Penance

St. Bridget's Church: Thursdays during Lent, following Stations of the Cross at 5:30pm. Exception: There will be no Confessions on Thursday, March 19 since the priests will be at the Bishop's installation that day.

St. Mary's Church: Saturdays at 3:45pm

Has it been a while since you've made the Sacrament of Penance? Unsure about what to do or say during Confession? Here's the general format:

(Optional) You can begin with "An Examination of Conscience" (this can be found on our website at <https://stbenedictonline.org/liturgy-at-stbenedict-parish>)

1. The priest will begin, "In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen."
2. You say to the priest, "Bless me Father, for I have sinned, it has been _ (how long) since my last confession."
3. Tell Father your sins.
4. Listen to what the priest tells you. He will give you advice, assign a penance, and ask you to say the Act of Contrition

(You can choose to say any Act of Contrition, including one of the following)

"Have mercy on me, O Lord, a sinner."

—OR—

"My God, I am sorry for my sins with all my heart. In doing wrong and failing to do good, I have sinned against you whom I should love above all things. I firmly intend, with your help, to do penance, to sin no more, and to avoid whatever leads me to sin. Amen."

GROWING IN THE FAITH



Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation, Junior High Youth Group, & Teen Youth Group

Upcoming Important Dates:

March 8:

- 10am, Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation, MS Youth Group
- 6pm—7pm, Confirmation Prep
- 7pm—8:15pm, Teen Youth Group

March 15:

- 10am, Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation, MS Youth Group

March 22:

- 10am, Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation, MS Youth Group
- 6pm—7pm, Confirmation Prep
- 7pm—8:15pm, Teen Youth Group

See the weekly update sent via Flocknote for more details. For the full schedule for Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation Middle School Youth Group, and Teen Youth Group, please visit <https://stbenedictonline.org/faith-formation>.

Contact: Sarah Herendeen, Sarah.Herendeen@dor.org or ext. 109

VACATION BIBLE SCHOOL—REGISTER TODAY FOR SUMMER 2026

St. Benedict Parish is excited to offer Vacation Bible School (VBS) this summer for children aged 4-11. VBS will be held **Monday, July 27-Friday, July 31** from 9am—noon at Notre Dame Retreat House, 5151 Foster Rd., Canandaigua. If you are interested in having your children attend, please register them using the online form at <https://stbenedictonline.org/vacation-bible-school>. Spaces are limited, so sign up today!

If you have any questions or if you would like to assist with the program, please contact Sarah Herendeen by using the contact information above.



SACRAMENTAL PREP

Baptismal Requests

Baptismal request forms and more information can be found on our website at stbenedictonline.org. Click on "Faith" and then "Sacraments".

Contact: Jennifer Abdalla, Jennifer.Abdalla@dor.org or ext. 141

First Penance & First Eucharist Prep

Eucharist Prep will begin on **Sunday, March 15** for registered participants in March.

Contact: Sarah Herendeen, Sarah.Herendeen@dor.org or ext. 109

Confirmation Prep, Years 1 & 2

Upcoming Important Dates:

March 8: 6pm—7pm, Confirmation Prep

March 22: 6pm—7pm, Confirmation Prep

April 16: WE HAVE A DATE! The Diocese has finalized the Confirmation Mass schedule and our parish will celebrate Confirmation on Thursday, **April 16, 2026** at 7pm in St. Mary's Church. More details will be sent out to registered families soon!

Contact: Amy Corron, Amy.Corron@dor.org or ext. 125

Marriage Requests

Marriage request forms and more information can be found on our website at stbenedictonline.org. Click on "Faith" and then "Sacraments". To inquire about a marriage date, please fill out the form and someone will be in touch with you.

Contact: Sarah Eaton, Sarah.Eaton@dor.org or ext. 137

OCIA/OCIC

Order of Christian Initiation of Adults (OCIA)/Order of Christian Initiation of Children (OCIC) is a process for those adults or children aged 7 and above who are interested in becoming Catholic, are Catholic but have not yet received all of the Sacraments, and/or are interested in renewing and understanding their Catholic faith.

To register for OCIA/OCIC, please visit <https://stbenedictonline.org/how-to-become-catholic-1> and fill out the online registration form.

Who joins OCIA? People just like you who, for example,

- May be non-Catholic but have a child receiving the sacraments soon and want to learn more about it for themselves
- Have been away from the Church for awhile and would like to update their knowledge of Church teachings
- Sitting in the pew next to their Catholic spouse for years wondering about becoming Catholic
- Made their First Communion but, for various reasons, never got around to making their Confirmation
- Love their Catholic Faith but feel they never had strong instruction as a child, teen, or young adult, and/or have felt a recurring encouragement to explore Catholicism.

Contact: OCIA/OCIC Team, StBenedictOCIA@gmail.com



EVENTS & ACTIVITIES: THIS WEEK, & UPCOMING

March 8, 2026

OUR PARISH: THIS WEEK AT A GLANCE

Sunday, March 8, 2026

During 9am Mass (SM) First Scrutiny/OCIA Dismissal
10am (SM) OCIA meeting in Dougherty Hall
10am (SMS) Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation & MS Youth Group
6pm (SM) Confirmation Prep in Dougherty Hall
7pm (SM) Teen Youth Group in Dougherty Hall

Monday, March 9, 2026

3pm (SM) Stephen Ministry leaders meeting in Dougherty Hall

Tuesday, March 10, 2026

9:30am (SB) Bloomfield Bees in the church hall
9:30am (SB) "Memories & Futures" gathering in the church hall
11am (SM) Chair stretching in Dougherty Hall
6:30pm (SB) Social Ministry meeting in the church hall
7pm (SM) Tithing Committee meeting in Dougherty Hall conference room

Wednesday, March 11, 2026

12pm (SB) Hands of Hope free lunch in the church hall
1:30pm (SM) St. Vincent de Paul meeting in Dougherty Hall
6pm (SM) Choir practice in church

Thursday, March 12, 2026

11am (SM) GriefShare meeting in Dougherty Hall
2pm (SM) Prayer Shawl in Dougherty Hall
5:30pm (SB) Stations of the Cross, followed by Confessions in church
6pm (SM) Knights of Columbus meeting in Dougherty Hall

Friday, March 13, 2026

6pm (SM) Stations of the Cross in church

Saturday, March 14, 2026

9:30am (SM) Rosary group in church
10am (SM) Hospice Presentation in Dougherty Hall
3pm (SB) Family Faith Formation—Stations of the Cross in St. Bridget's Church
3:45pm (SM) Confessions in church

Sunday, March 15, 2026

During 9am Mass (SM) First Scrutiny/OCIA Dismissal
10am (SM) OCIA meeting in Dougherty Hall
10am (SMS) Pre-K—Grade 5 Faith Formation & MS Youth Group
1pm (SM) First Eucharist prep in Dougherty Hall

(SB) St. Bridget's Church, (SM) St. Mary's Church, (SMS) St. Mary's School

Note: Schedule is current at the time of publication. These events and activities are subject to change. Please watch for any changes to be sent via Flocknote, to be updated on the calendar on our website, or to be posted on our Facebook page.

MORE DETAILS ABOUT THIS WEEK'S & UPCOMING EVENTS AT OUR PARISH

St. Vincent de Paul Monthly Meeting

Please consider attending the St. Vincent de Paul Society March meeting on **Wednesday, March 11** from 1:30pm-3pm in Dougherty Hall. As we continue our Lenten journey towards Easter Sunday, we invite you to join us and see who we are and how we work together to fulfill our mission of assisting our neediest sisters and brothers in the Greater Canandaigua community! The Lenten season provides an excellent time to help others less fortunate than ourselves. Why not take advantage of the opportunity?

Free Meal Wednesdays

The Hands of Hope Kitchen serves a noon meal **Wednesdays** in the parish hall of St. Bridget's Church, Bloomfield. Come join us for delicious food, friends, and fellowship. The meal is free and without obligation, and ALL are welcome—individuals, couples, and families.

More about Hands of Hope: The Hands of Hope Kitchen is a community based program that welcomes and relies on volunteer and financial support from the local community. We believe that we are all one in community, and strive to respect the dignity of those who come to us for a meal. Our meals are offered without charge, requirement, or question. For more information, please visit <https://www.handsofhopekitchen.org/>

Meat Raffle—Canceled

Unfortunately, due to low ticket sales, St. Mary's School PTO and the business office of St. Benedict Parish have made the difficult decision to cancel this year's event.

While the Meat Raffle will not take place on March 13, the PTO plans to bring it back during its traditional November timeframe for the 2026-2027 school year.



All Are Welcome to Attend a Special Presentation "Understanding Hospice Care" Hosted by Stephen Ministry

Have you ever wondered what hospice care really is, or how it supports individuals and families during life's most difficult moments? Our parish Stephen Ministry invites you to a special presentation by Suzanne Underhill RN, Resident Care Director of Light Hill Comfort Care Home in Canandaigua. Suzanne will share insights into the compassionate care hospice provides. This presentation will help deepen your understanding of how hospice supports not only physical needs, but also emotional and spiritual well-being at the end of life. All are welcome to attend this presentation on **Saturday, March 14** in St. Mary's Dougherty Hall at 10am (following the 9am Mass).

Stations of the Cross for Kids & Families—Date Change!

Please join us for our monthly Family Faith Formation gathering on **Saturday, March 21** at 3pm in St. Bridget's Church. This month, we will offer Stations of the Cross for kids and families. You do not need to be part of our Faith Formation program to attend. All are welcome!



MORE DETAILS ABOUT THIS WEEK'S EVENTS AT OUR PARISH

"Memories" Group

All are welcome to attend the "Memories & Futures" group will gather in St. Bridget's hall after the 9am Mass on **Tuesday, February 17**. This group meets weekly. You don't have to have been part of the group in fall to come to this upcoming series of gatherings; you just need to have wonderful memories of your time spent at St. Bridget's and want to share that with others.

Find Stillness in the Season: A Lenten Chair Stretch & Reflect Series

Prepare your heart and body for Easter with this 6-week gentle movement series. **Each Tuesday through March 31**, we will meet in Dougherty Hall at 11am and use seated stretching, strengthening, and deep breathing to release physical tension while centering our minds on the journey of Lent. This class is designed for all mobility levels—no special equipment is required—just a desire to find quiet and renewal. Weekly Themes - Week 1: Grace, Week 2: Forgiveness, Week 3: Surrender, Week 4: Gratitude, Week 5: Joy, and Week 6: Love. Join us to stretch, breathe, and reflect as we journey through the season together. No registration necessary.

EVENTS & ACTIVITIES: UPCOMING

Third Sunday of Lent

MORE UPCOMING PARISH EVENTS

Weekly Wellness Workshop beginning April 7

Facilitated by Jennifer Marks Muscato of UR Thompson Health, Sponsored by the Social Ministry Committee

Take the driver's seat in your own health with our immersive weekly workshop designed to empower the whole person. Rather than focusing on a single habit, we explore the interconnected pillars of well-being—physical, emotional, and social—to help you build a sustainable, personalized toolkit for life. Please pre-register for this six-week series (meeting **Tuesdays** at 1pm in Dougherty Hall from **April 7 – May 19**, no class on May 5) by emailing jmuscato14@hotmail.com or by calling the PAC at (585) 394-1220, ext. 110.

Session Highlights:

- **Holistic Balance:** Understand how different dimensions of wellness, such as physical vitality and emotional resilience, affect one another.
- **Practical Tools:** Walk away with actionable strategies for stress management, mindful movement, and healthy habit mapping.
- **Shared Growth:** Connect with fellow parishioners in a supportive, community-driven environment that values personal responsibility and mutual encouragement.
- **Personalized Action:** Create a custom plan to navigate your wellness journey with confidence.

This program is open to everyone seeking to move from reactive to proactive health, providing a space for restoration and renewal within our community.

Save the Date—SevenElevenish Event

SevenElevenish will be returning this year and all are welcome to attend on **Sunday, July 12** at the Bloomfield campus! See our ministry section on page 9 in this bulletin for additional information, and watch for updates to be posted as the event gets nearer.

LENTEN RETREATS AT NOTRE DAME RETREAT HOUSE

Notre Dame Retreat House has many upcoming events, including the following Lenten Retreat. Please consider adding this to your calendar:

- **March 24:** “Do Not Judge Anyone: Desert Wisdom for a Polarized World” Lenten retreat day led by Fr. Isaac Slater, OCSO (author)

To register or for more information about this event and more: Call (585) 394-5700, scan the QR code, or visit notredameretreat.org.



FAMILY PROMISE BOWL-A-THON

Join Family Promise of Ontario County for bowling, dinner, 50/50, basket raffle, prizes, and a whole lot of fun at a Bowl-A-Thon at Roseland Bowl, 4357 Recreation Drive, Canandaigua, on **Saturday, April 11, 2026** from 4pm -7pm. Cost is \$40 per player or \$200 for a team of 5, and includes 2 games of bowling, dinner, soft drinks, and great fun. Please call (585) 905-3988, visit <https://www.bowlathon.net/event/family-promise-2026>, or scan the QR code for more information or to register.



LENTEN HAPPENINGS AT OUR PARISH Stations of the Cross

- Stations for Kids & Families on **Saturday, March 21** at 3pm in St. Bridget's Church (see page 6 for more info)
- **Thursdays in Lent** through **March 26** at 5:30pm in St. Bridget's Church. Note: Confessions will follow Stations each week except for March 19 as the priests will be at the Bishop's installation that day.
- **Fridays in Lent** through **March 27** at 6pm in St. Mary's Church (note earlier time, changed Lent, Week 2)
- Outdoor Stations of the Cross on **Good Friday, April 3** at 10am at Notre Dame Retreat House

Lenten Evening Prayer

- **Sundays in Lent** at 4pm
 - At St. Mary's on **February 22, March 8, and March 22**
 - At St. Bridget's on **March 1, March 15, and March 29**

St. Joseph's Table

- **Friday, March 20**—The installation of the new Bishop will take place on March 19, so will plan to celebrate St. Joseph's Table on the following day. Mass will be held at 11am at St. Mary's (there will be no 9am Mass that day), and St. Joseph's Table will be held in Dougherty Hall following the 11am Mass. All are welcome. Watch for additional information to come.

Days of Penance & Mercy

The Diocesan Day of Penance and Mercy is scheduled for Tuesday, March 24. There will be numerous opportunities for Penance on that day and throughout the week within the Diocese of Rochester. At our parish, we will be offering the following opportunities:

- **Wednesday, March 25**—Confessions from 10am–1pm and from 3pm–7pm at St. Mary's Church
- **Thursday, March 26**—Stations of the Cross at 5:30pm at St. Bridget's Church, followed by Confessions

Watch for more events, including our Holy Week events, to be posted in upcoming bulletins and communicated via Flocknote.

LENT 2026: LIVING LENT DAILY

How can you “Live Lent Daily”?

Things to consider:

- **Don't skip Sunday rest.** This is best for workaholics (or procrastinators). Honoring the Sabbath at God intended creates a space for worship and reflection. Focusing on letting go of work for a full day requires trust in God's providence.
- **Stop rushing through life.** This is best for individuals who often feel overwhelmed. Slowing down requires intentionality and effort to say no to unnecessary busyness, but it can teach mindfulness, help you live in the present, and draw you closer to God's pace.
- **Give up talking about yourself excessively.** This is best for those who tend to (accidentally or not) dominate conversations. Developing self-awareness in conversations can be surprisingly tough, but this practice encourages humility and a greater interest in others.

STEWARDSHIP: TIME, TALENT, & TREASURE

March 8, 2026

GIVING TO ST. MARY'S SCHOOL

SMS Annual Fund

Please prayerfully consider:

- giving financially
- volunteering your time or talent
- inviting others to participate
- spreading the word about our Annual Fund
- praying for the St. Mary's community and the success of this year's Annual Fund



Fundraisers

Sarris Candies: Our annual candy fundraiser is here! Visit www.sarris Candiesfundraising.com and enter our Group ID# (10-0634) to shop (if it asks for seller, leave blank). Browse from hundreds of your favorite Sarris Candies products and checkout online. Online Ordering is open **through March 22**. Your order will be shipped directly to your house and our group will earn 25% profit! Shop for Valentine's, Easter and general occasion candy and nuts!! Some non-chocolate and sugar free options as well!

Ryan's Wine & Spirits:

SUPPORTING OUR PARISH WITH A BOOKPLATE DEDICATION

Dedicate a Hymnal or Missal

Our new hymnals and missals offer a meaningful way to honor or remember someone special. Personalized bookplates will be placed inside each dedicated volume. To see samples of the bookplates and to request a dedication, please complete the online form at stbenedictonline.org/giving. Cost—Hymnal dedication: \$28, Missal dedication: \$23. Thank you for your generosity and support of our parish worship!



SUPPORTING SMS & CMA

Pot-of-Gold Fundraiser

The Knights of Columbus Council #1445 will be selling Pot-of-Gold raffle tickets after weekend Masses **through March 15**. The drawing will be held on **St. Patrick's Day, March 17**. The first place winner will receive \$1000 and the second place winner will receive \$500. Only 100 tickets will be sold, so be sure to get yours today! In addition to St. Mary's School, proceeds will also go to the Catholic Ministries Appeal (CMA). Thank you for supporting the Knights of Columbus, our parish, school, and diocese!



GIVING TO ST. BENEDICT PARISH

Weekly Offertory*—February, 2026

Avg Weekly Offertory Income for the Month of Feb: **\$22,434**

**Average weekly offertory numbers for the prior month will be posted in the bulletin. Each week's offertory numbers and the year to date numbers are available on our website.*

Online Giving through Our Sunday Visitor (OSV):

Did you know? You can scan the QR code to the right to sign up for or to give to any of the following: Sunday and holy day offertories, SMS annual fund, faith formation, sacramental prep, and cemetery funds. If you are unable to give online, your offertory can be placed in the collection basket at Mass or be mailed to the PAC. Many thanks!



GIVING TO THE DIOCESE

2025-2026 Catholic Ministries Appeal—Together We Bring Hope... and Hope Does Not Disappoint

Our parish has been asked to contribute \$195,000 to the CMA this year. **As of March 2, 2026, we have had 424 donors, and our goal is to exceed 500 donors this year.** Thank you to those who have already given. If you have not yet responded, please prayerfully consider a gift. Every gift to the CMA helps those in need, supports the mission of the Church, and comes back to help our parish. You may place your gift in a marked envelope and place it in the collection basket, or pay securely online at <https://www.dor.org/giving/catholic-ministries-appeal/>. Thank you for your consideration and for assisting us in meeting our goal.



GIVING TO THE COMMUNITY

St. Vincent de Paul Society

Clothing & Voucher Rooms: 120 N. Main St, Canandaigua. The Clothing Room is open 10am-12:30pm on Wednesday, Friday, & Saturday, and the Voucher Room is open 10am-noon on Wednesday & Friday.

Donations of clothing and other usable items can be brought to the Clothing Room during regular business hours.

There is also a need for reusable bags for our patrons. Thank you for your support and donations for those in need in our community.

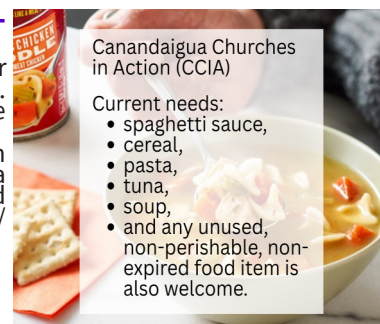
Coffee for Hospice

The 'Coffee for Hospice' collection began last weekend and will conclude at the end of Lent. K of C collection boxes are at all entrances of St. Mary's and main entrance to St. Bridget's. The local hospices are requesting "K-cups only". Not only are K-cups more convenient for the hospice staff, but there are no wasted pots of coffee. The coffee is to help bring some comfort to family members while visiting with their loved ones during their last days in hospice at Light Hill in Canandaigua, Serenity House in Victor, and House of John in Clifton Springs.

CCIA Food Pantry—Current Needs

Thank you so much for your continued support. Please see the graphic to the right for our current needs.

For more information about the Canandaigua Churches in Action (CCIA) food pantry, please visit <https://www.churchesinaction.org/services.html>.



STEWARDSHIP: MINISTRIES & SUPPORT

Third Sunday of Lent

WANT TO GET INVOLVED? OUR MINISTRIES WELCOME NEW MEMBERS!

At our parish, stewardship is both promoted and encouraged. Stewardship is a way of life -- a way that is dedicated to the giving of ourselves by offering God things that are most dear to us in our lives: our time, our talent, and our treasure.

There are so many ways to share your time, talents, and treasures! One of them is by participating in one or more of our parish ministries. We invite you to look through the lists below to see which you may have interest in.

Liturgical Ministries: Altar Servers, Extraordinary Ministers of Holy Communion (EMoHC) — Visitation and at Masses, Funeral Preparation Team, Greeters, Jail Ministry, Lectors, Music Ministry, Sacristans, Ushers

Ministries that Help Others Prepare to Receive the Sacraments: Baptismal Preparation Team, Confirmation Preparation, First Penance and First Eucharist Preparation, Marriage Preparation Team, OCIA/OCIC

Ministries that Help Us Connect to One Another and Learn More about our Faith: Catholic Men's Group, Faith Formation & Youth Ministry, Knights of Columbus, Mothers of Young Children Ministry, St. Mary's School, Walking with Purpose, Women's Prayer Ministry, Young Adult Ministry

Ministries that Maintain Parish Spaces: Buildings & Grounds, Cemetery Committee & Cemetery Project, Cleaning Ministry, Garden Ministry, Lawn Care Ministry

Ministries that Promote Stewardship & Community Building: Festival Committee, Stewardship Ministry

Support Ministries that Help Others Who May be Sick, Grieving, Less Fortunate, and/or in Need: Blessing Room, Bloomfield Bees, Elizabeth Ministry, Family Promise of Ontario County, GriefShare, Migrant Ministry, Prayer Shawl Ministry, Social Ministry, Stephen Ministry, St. Vincent de Paul Society

Want to know more about any of the parish ministries on the lists above? More details about our ministries, including contact information, can be found by calling our parish office or by visiting stbenedictonline.org and clicking on "Get Involved" at the top of the page. Additionally, you may learn more about some of our ministries by going to an upcoming meeting.

PARISH & DIOCESAN SUPPORT RESOURCES

If you are struggling, please know that you are not alone. Our parish is here to support you through pastoral care and these and our other ministries.

GriefShare—Our GriefShare support group begins **March 12, 2026**. All meetings are on Thursdays from 11am-1pm in Dougherty Hall. At GriefShare you'll watch a weekly video featuring respected counselors and Christian professionals on grief-related topics. After that a small group discussion allows participants a time of sharing, support and personal application of what they learned in the video. Also, group participants receive a book with valuable exercises for navigating their personal grieving process. To learn more about this group, please call (585) 210-0048 or email stbgriefshare@gmail.com.

Stephen Ministry: You Are Not Alone This Lent—Lent is a sacred season of reflection, repentance, and drawing closer to Christ. It is also a time when we may become more aware of the burdens we carry—grief, illness, loneliness, worry, or personal struggles. You do not have to carry these burdens alone. Our parish Stephen Ministers are here to walk with you during this Lenten season. Stephen Ministers are trained parishioners who provide confidential, one-to-one care through listening, encouragement, and prayer. They offer a compassionate presence rooted in the love of Christ. Sometimes the most meaningful step toward healing is simply sharing your journey with someone who cares. As we follow Christ on the road to the Cross, we are reminded that He walks with us—and often makes His presence known through one another. If you would like to be connected with a Stephen Minister, please contact Jennifer Abdalla, Director of Parish Ministries, at (585) 394-1220 ext. 141.

Elizabeth Ministry: A Catholic Support Network for Miscarriage, Stillbirth, and Infant Loss—As local Catholic women who have experienced the loss of a child, our goal is to offer emotional, spiritual, and practical support to women and families suffering through a similar loss. Masses of Healing for Miscarriage and Infant Loss are offered twice annually in the Diocese of Rochester. For more information about the Mass or if you or a loved one are seeking support or are interested in joining our mailing list, contact Molly Hickey at ElizabethMinistryROC@gmail.com or Janene Loughran at (585) 329-1974.

Project Rachel in the Diocese of Rochester—Through Project Rachel, the DOR has a network of specially trained priests, religious, counselors, and laypersons who accompany anyone struggling in the aftermath of abortion whether it was recently or several years ago. A trained companion is available to guide you on a confidential, nonjudgmental healing process of forgiveness and peace. If you or someone you know needs hope after abortion, help is available through our dedicated helpline: 888-9RACHEL (888-972-2435).

Prayer Shawl Ministry & Bloomfield Bees—The Prayer Shawl ministry has created various items for those who need extra comfort during times of illness and anxiety: knitted blankets and crocheted blankets for infants, fleece blankets for young children and teenagers, and prayer shawls for anyone in need. If you would be in need, please contact Bev at (585) 657-7042 or Rose Anne at (585) 729-9767 or call the PAC. Prayer shawls are readily available at the PAC and at the main entrance to St. Bridget's church hall.

The Bloomfield Bees is a sewing group that is a part of our Prayer Shawl ministry. They meet on Tuesday mornings at St. Bridget's Church. This group creates various items for donation and fundraising efforts for our communities. For more information or to join, please call Rose Anne at (585) 729-9767.

MINISTRY UPDATES & INFORMATION

Cemetery Committee & Project

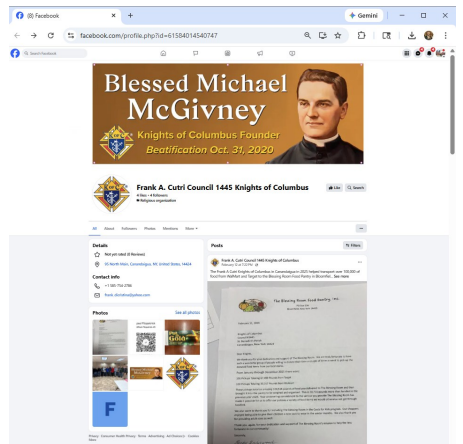
At the coffee hour after the 10:30 am Mass at St. Bridget's last weekend, Deacon Claude reviewed the cemetery project he has been working on since late summer and outlined ways for parishioners to become involved in the coming months. A full list of opportunities will be available on the parish website, under "Cemeteries". There are activities which will need an hour of volunteer service and some that will require more. The activities are not limited to the Bloomfield community; anyone can help. And since the culminating event: SevenElevenish will be held for the entire parish on **Sunday, July 12** at the Bloomfield campus, all are welcome to participate in the preparations for it.

What is SevenElevenish? When the two parishes of St. Mary's in Canandaigua and St. Bridget's in Bloomfield formed the new parish, St. Benedict, in 2007, we started the SevenElevenish event as a way to bring both communities together and celebrate the patronal feast day of St. Benedict. (We call it SevenElevenish because we celebrate it on the Sunday closest to the actual feast of St. Benedict, which is July 11.)

On the website we will have a list of the many ways people can provide input and energy into the work over these next coming months. These pages are copies of what was distributed at the February 1 coffee hour. Feel free to contact Deacon Claude at sectionrowplot@gmail.com with any questions.

Knights of Columbus New Facebook Page

Please like and follow the new Frank A. Cutri K of C Council #1445 page on Facebook at <https://www.facebook.com/profile.php?id=61584014540747&sk=followers> or by searching for the council by name.



CONTACT US

March 8, 2026



Drawing by Larry M. Kay

Parish Administration Center (PAC)

(Updated) Office Hours:

Mon: 9am-12pm, 1pm-4pm
Tues: 9:30am-12pm, 1pm-4:30pm
Wed: 9:30am-12pm, 1pm-4:30pm
Thurs: 9:30am-12pm, 1pm-4:30pm
Fri: 9am-12:30pm, 1pm-2pm

St. Benedict Parish Staff

Father Michael Costik <i>Pastor</i>	Fr.Michael.Costik@dor.org 394-1220, x111
Father Simon Atta Denchira <i>Parochial Vicar</i>	Fr.Simon.Denchira@dor.org 394-1220, x134
Deacon Kevin Carges <i>Parish Deacon</i>	Kevin.Carges@dor.org
Jennifer Abdalla <i>Director of Stewardship & Pastoral Ministries</i>	Jennifer.Abdalla@dor.org 394-1220, x141
Sarah Eaton <i>Director of Music Ministry</i>	Sarah.Eaton@dor.org 394-1220, x137
Amy Corron <i>Director of Communications & Liturgy</i>	Amy.Corron@dor.org 394-1220, x125
Sarah Herendeen <i>Director of Faith Formation</i>	Sarah.Herendeen@dor.org 394-1220, x109
Nancy Apolito <i>Director of Finance & Administration</i>	Nancy.Apolito@dor.org 394-1220, x124
Maureen Horrocks <i>Receptionist</i>	Maureen.Horrocks@dor.org 394-1220, x110
Angela Lenzo <i>Receptionist</i>	Angela.Lenzo@dor.org 394-1220, x110
Patti Carter <i>Business Manager</i>	Patricia.Carter@dor.org 394-1220, x115
Mara Tew <i>Bookkeeper</i>	Mara.Tew@dor.org 394-1220, x142
Rich Clayton, Laurent Paré, & Tarra Morrice <i>Maintenance & Grounds</i>	Rich.Clayton@dor.org 394-1220, x118
St. Benedict Cemeteries <i>Calvary Cemetery, St. Bridget's Cemetery</i>	st.benedictcemeteries@dor.org 394-1220, x133

2024-2025 Parish Pastoral Council

Chairperson: Steve DeMott; **Council Members:** Brenda Abel (Vice Chairperson), Amy Noto (Secretary), Soni Beecher, Mike Broderick, Mia Gibbons, Diana Guilford, JoAnne Fassinger, Kathy Johnson, Rick Monnat, Angi Salerno, Rosemary Smith. 1st Alt: Nick Laskowski, 2nd Alt: John Bodine; **Ex officio members:** Jennifer Abdalla, Nancy Apolito, Amy Corron, Fr. Simon Atta Denchira, Sarah Eaton, Cristina Falbo, and Sarah Herendeen

Parish Finance Council

Chairperson: Rick McMullen
Council Members: Colleen Delaney, Mike Klotz, Kathy Shaw, & Jim Weisbeck

WELCOME

Welcome home! Whether you are new to the area, are just joining the Catholic Church, or are a long-time parishioner, welcome home! All are welcome!
For visitors and those new to the parish: Thank you for joining us! St. Benedict Parish is a vibrant religious community with rich worship, an exceptional and established parochial school, many active ministries, and lively activities. We invite people to visit both of our worship sites: St. Bridget's Church in Bloomfield and St. Mary's Church in Canandaigua. We warmly welcome those who desire to share in our community life. When you are at St. Benedict Parish, you are home!



St. Mary's School

Office Hours:
Monday - Friday, 8am—3:30pm

Founded
1849
Faith in every
student!

St. Mary's School Office

Cristina Falbo
Principal

Cristina.Falbo@dor.org
394-4300, x202

Pamela Negley
Administrative Assistant

Pamela.Negley@dor.org
smcdcs@dor.org
394-4300, x201



ST. MARY'S SCHOOL NOW ENROLLING

2026-2027

Preschool-Grade 6
Small Class Sizes - Faith Filled- Character
Building-Academic Excellence



**FOR MORE
INFORMATION**

585-394-4300 ex 201

<https://stmaryscanandaigua.org/registration>



**2026 Annual Fund
GIVE TODAY!**



Thank you for supporting Catholic education!
St. Mary School Canandaigua, NY

**Now, more than ever, our children need Catholic education.
Now, more than ever, our children need St. Mary's School.
Now, more than ever, we need St. Mary's School.**